
SOFTWARE REQUIREMENTS SPECIFICATION

for

Examen - Sacrament of Reconciliation
Application

Release 1.0

Version 1.0 approved

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Revision History

Date	Description	Revised by
xx/xx/xx	Initial release	Team name

1 INTRODUCTION

1.1 Purpose

The purpose of this document is to outline the functional and non-functional requirements for Examen, a Windows Forms application designed to guide users through the Sacrament of Reconciliation within the Catholic Church. This document specifies how the system will operate, its intended users, and the core functionalities it must provide.

1.2 Document Conventions

This Software Requirements Specification follows the IEEE Standards Style Manual for documenting software requirements. Furthermore, throughout this document, the term "shall" indicates a mandatory requirement that must be implemented in the final product, "should" refers to a suggested feature but is not a required one, and "may" refers to an optional feature that could be implemented in future releases.

1.3 Acronyms

Term	Definition
Examination of Conscience	A reflective review of one's actions to recall sins before confession.
Reconciliation / Confession	The Catholic sacrament in which sins are confessed and absolved.
Mortal Sin	A grave sin that separates one from God's grace until confessed.
Venial Sin	A lesser sin that weakens but does not break one's relationship with God.
WinForms	Microsoft's Windows Forms GUI framework for desktop applications.

1.4 Project Scope

Examen is a desktop application built using C and Windows Forms that leads users through the Sacrament of Reconciliation step-by-step. The application provides instructional prompts, prayers, and scriptural insights at each stage. It allows users to perform an interactive examination of conscience, select sins based on category and severity, and prepare a printable summary to take into confession. The program also links to official Church resources to assist users with theological questions or spiritual preparation.

2 OVERALL DESCRIPTION

2.0.1 Product Perspective

Examen is a standalone Windows desktop application. It does not require an internet connection to function but may include hyperlinks to online Catholic resources for users who are connected. The system will consist of several main screens:

- **Examination Screen** – Allows users to review and select sins.
- **Prayer & Guidance Screen** – Allows users to add prayers and Sacrament practice information.
- **Final Output Screen** – Displays the generated summary and provides export options (e.g., PDF).

2.0.2 Product Features

The system will provide the following functions:

- Guide users through the Sacrament of Reconciliation step-by-step.
- Provide an interactive examination of conscience based on sin categories.
- Allow users to select sins and note their severity.
- Include educational links for questions about Church teaching.
- Generate a printable or savable PDF summary of the user's preparation.
- Include built-in prayers and guides to aid in sacramental preparation.

2.0.3 User Characteristics

- Practicing Catholics seeking a structured way to prepare for confession.
- Converts and new Catholics unfamiliar with the process of Reconciliation.
- Users will generally have basic computer literacy but no technical expertise.

2.0.4 Constraints

- Must be developed using C# and WinForms.
- Must operate offline once installed.
- Must not store or transmit personal/confessional data externally.
- Must complete all local operations (PDF generation, UI transitions) within 2 seconds.

3 REQUIREMENTS

3.1 FUNCTIONAL REQUIREMENTS

1. The system shall guide users through each stage of the Sacrament of Reconciliation.
2. The system shall present an interactive checklist of sins categorized by the Ten Commandments and Church Precepts.
3. The system shall allow users to mark sins as mortal or venial and record related notes.
4. The system shall provide preset prayers (e.g., Act of Contrition) and optional practice aids that can be attached to the user's output.
5. The system shall generate a PDF summary of selected sins, notes, and prayers for user reference.
6. The system shall provide links to trusted Catholic resources explaining relevant topics (e.g., Catechism entries).
7. The system shall display validation messages if mandatory fields are incomplete before generating output.

3.2 NONFUNCTIONAL REQUIREMENTS

3.2.1 Performance Requirements

1. All windows shall load within 2 seconds on a standard Windows 10 machine.

3.2.2 Security Requirements

1. No user data shall be stored permanently or transmitted online.

3.2.3 Software Quality Attributes

1. The interface shall use clear labels, logical navigation, and consistent layout.
2. The system shall remain stable during extended use without data loss.
3. The application shall run on Windows 10 or later.
4. The source code shall be modular, with comments and documentation for future updates.

4 USE CASES

Use Case ID	Use Case Name	Description	Actor
UC-001	Perform Examination of Conscience	User reviews moral actions based on categories (Ten Commandments, virtues, etc.)	User
UC-002	Save Confession to PDF	System generates a formatted PDF summary of the examination or confession guide	User
UC-003	Get Prayers for Confession	User retrieves or displays traditional prayers (Act of Contrition, Prayer Before Confession, etc.)	User
UC-004	Get Guidance on Confession	App provides instructions, tips, or Catechism excerpts on how to confess properly	User
UC-005	Get Info on Confession	Shows general teaching about the Sacrament of Reconciliation (scriptural, theological, or catechetical background)	User
UC-006	Reset Examination	Allows the user to clear all previous selections or start over	User

Use Case ID:	UC-001
Use Case Name:	Perform Examination of Conscience
Actor(s):	User
Description:	The user reviews a list of sins categorized by the Ten Commandments and selects the ones they have committed.
Preconditions:	User has opened the Examen application
Postconditions / Success Guarantee:	User's selected sins are recorded and can be added to the final PDF summary.
Trigger:	User clicks the Examination Screen button.
Main Flow:	1. User opens the Examination Screen. 2. The system displays categories of sins. 3. User selects sins they have committed and marks if they are mortal. 3a. User inputs their own sin committed. 4. System records selections for use in generating the final output. 5. System moves on to next stage (Prayers and Guidance)
Alternate Flows:	1. User deselects a previously selected sin. 2. User exits the examination without saving (system prompts confirmation). 3. User presses "Clear" button 4. User presses "Reset" button

5 STANDARDS AND REFERENCES

5.1 Applicable Standards

5.2 References